APTOHIRE

Customer Validation & Interview Insights

Evidence status, research design, and survey-analysis protocol

PRODUCT THESIS
Make practical capability visible through evidence—not just claims on a resume.

Product: AptoHire | **Website:** aptohire.vercel.app

Document: IDEA-05 | **Version:** 1.0 | **Date:** 30 October 2026

Audience: Hackathon judges, university partners, product team and prospective investors

This document separates founder-provided context, proposed product direction, and claims that require measured validation.

AptoHire

Executive status

Survey status
The founder confirms that the team conducted an online survey and provided the form link. The linked form is not a response export, and no response dataset or accessible results summary was available for this report. No respondent counts, percentages, quotes or findings are invented.

Evidence currently available

Evidence	What it supports	What it does not establish
Founder-provided product documents	Product direction, intended workflows and hypotheses.	Customer demand, accuracy or commercial traction.
LinkedIn anecdote shared by founder	Illustrates how a CV can underrepresent capability.	Frequency or prevalence of the problem.
Team online survey (confirmed by founder)	That a survey was conducted.	Survey findings until questions and response data are reviewed.
Live product link	A place to inspect the current experience.	Feature completion or reliability without direct feature verification.

Research questions

- How often do students struggle to demonstrate practical skills beyond their CV?
- What evidence do recruiters trust, and what does it cost in time to verify?
- Would universities use aggregate skill-gap evidence to change training or placement preparation?
- Will students submit project evidence and trust the feedback and consent model?
- Who is the buyer, who controls budget, and what workflow must AptoHire fit?
- What are the unacceptable errors, privacy concerns and fairness requirements?

Recommended discovery sample

Group	Target for future research	Purpose
Students / early-career candidates	15–20 interviews	Understand current behavior, proof-building and trust.
Recruiters / hiring managers	10–15 interviews	Understand screening workflow, evidence needs and budget.
University placement teams	About 5 interviews	Understand placement workflow, procurement and success criteria.
Potential pilot employers	3–5 deeper sessions	Test profile usefulness and secure a concrete next step.

Interview prompts

Students: Tell me about the last role you applied for. What evidence did you use? Which parts were inspected? What frustrated you about tests or portfolios? What would you share publicly versus after approving a request? What would make you distrust an AI assessment?

Recruiters: Walk me through the last 20 junior candidates screened. How do you verify a skill claim? What evidence would change your decision? What error would be unacceptable? Who approves and pays for a new tool?

Universities: What data shows practical readiness before placement drives? Which skill gaps recur? What report would change a training decision? Who owns procurement? What privacy or integration requirements could block a pilot?

Survey analysis protocol

- Capture the exact question wording, collection dates, respondent count, recruitment channel and missing responses.
- Segment students, recruiters, university staff and other groups rather than pooling unlike respondents.
- Show the denominator for every percentage and disclose convenience sampling or self-selection.
- Use quotations only when present in the source data and remove identifying details.
- Separate reported behavior from stated preference and researcher interpretation.
- Report negative findings and contradictions as well as positive findings.
- Treat stated interest as weaker evidence than completed tasks, repeated use, pilot commitment or payment.

What is needed to complete empirical findings

From the Google Form owner, export the response data as CSV or link the response destination to a spreadsheet and provide an accessible export. Include the questionnaire and collection dates. Google's official guidance describes exporting responses from the Responses tab as CSV or linking them to Sheets. The public responder URL alone does not guarantee access to owner-only response data.

Official guidance: Google Forms — View and manage responses: https://support.google.com/docs/answer/139706

Conclusion
AptoHire has a coherent problem narrative and a founder-confirmed survey. The empirical validation story is not complete until the questionnaire and response data are analyzed. This report intentionally makes that limitation explicit.

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